

powers bitcoin,” this article quietly questioned the need for the native asset, instead emphasizing the underlying technology. Masters was a well-known and respected figure in financial services, one that people associated with financial innovation. Her choice to join a little-known firm at the time called Digital Asset Holdings, after having been the head of global commodities at JPMorgan Chase, was reason to believe that blockchain technology was no longer on the fringe of the business world. In the article, a quote from Masters brought everyone to attention: “You should be taking this technology as seriously as you should have been taking the development of the Internet in the early 1990s. It’s analogous to email for money.”

The October 31, 2015, issue of the *Economist* featured “The Trust Machine” on its front cover, and while the article tipped its hat to Bitcoin, its focus was the more broadly applicable “technology behind bitcoin” and used the term *blockchain* throughout.¹⁴

The combination of Masters, Bloomberg, and the *Economist* led to a spike in interest in blockchain technology that set off a sustained climb in global Google search volumes for “blockchain” that is still in an upward trend. In the two weeks between October 18 and November 1, 2015, just after Bloomberg and the *Economist* published their articles, global Google search volumes for “blockchain” grew 70 percent (see [Figure 3.2](#)).